



United States
Attorney's Office
District of Oregon



Former Chief Financial Officer Pleads Guilty to Theft in Connection with Health Care

Friday, June 6, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, District of Oregon

PORTLAND, Ore.—The former Chief Financial Officer of Pacific States Marine Fisheries Commission (PSMFC) pleaded guilty Thursday for stealing money from PSMFC's health benefit trust account.

Pamela J. Kahut, 67, of Wilsonville, Oregon, pleaded guilty to theft in connection with health care.

According to court documents, Kahut, as Chief Financial Officer of PSFMC, had access to and controlled PSMFC's health benefit trust account that was created to pay benefits, fees, and other charges for PSFMC employees covered under its self-funded health care benefit program.

On September 21, 2020, Kahut wrote a check in the amount of \$2,812.85 from the health benefit trust account to pay for her spouse's participation in PSFMC's long-term care insurance program.

In total, between October 2014 and September 2020, defendant stole approximately \$211,083 from PSMFC's health benefit trust account. Kahut used the funds to pay for her spouse's long-term care annual premiums, pay off her pension loans, and to pay her credit card bills.

Theft in connection with health care fraud is punishable up to 10 years in federal prison and three years' supervised release. The charge may also result in a fine of up to \$250,000 or twice the gross gains or losses resulting from the offense.

Kahut will be sentenced on September 3, 2025, before a U.S. District Judge.

This case was investigated by the FBI, U.S. Department of Commerce Office of Inspector General, and U.S. Department of Energy Office of Inspector General. It is being prosecuted by Robert Trisotto, Assistant U.S. Attorney for the District of Oregon.

Updated June 6, 2025

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